

Katerina Eka Zinich

product designer

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Product Designer specialising in reducing cognitive load within complex, high-stress environments by grounding product development in user evidence and psychology. Combining WCAG 2.2 accessibility standards with AI-accelerated research, I bridge the gap between business goals and technical execution. My experience spans enterprise-level optimisations for high-traffic retailers like Officeworks to distilling startup concepts into scalable MVPs at Navis Sideralis.

Employment

Product Designer

Navis Sideralis | November 2025 – Present

Collaborating with startups to distill early-stage concepts into structured, scalable digital products. Focused on grounding features in user evidence and strategic roadmapping to ensure long-term commercial viability.

- **Research and Strategy:** Conducted in-depth user interviews and research to identify core pain points and market opportunities.
- **MVP Definition:** Defined Minimum Viable Products by prioritising features that balance user needs with immediate business goals.
- **Design System Creation:** Built and documented scalable design systems from the ground up. This ensured visual consistency and provided a clear library for tech squads to accelerate development.
- **Implementation Roadmapping:** Developed detailed roadmaps for product implementation to ensure a clear path from design to launch.
- **Technical Integration:** Collaborated with developers to align design specifications with technical sprints, ensuring timely and high-quality releases.

Product Designer (UX/UI)

Officeworks | Dec 2024 – Sep 2025

Optimised high-traffic e-commerce experiences by translating user insights into measurable design improvements. Worked in cross-functional squads to deliver user-friendly, technically feasible solutions.

- **Stakeholder Partnership:** Engaged business and IT leads to translate high-level objectives into technical design artefacts, ensuring alignment across the product vision.
- **Data-Driven Iteration:** Used analytics and user feedback to refine front-end UI. This successfully reduced bounce rates and improved the customer journey during peak periods.
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Balanced usability with technical constraints alongside engineers and product leads to ensure seamless execution.
- **Process Efficiency:** Introduced pre-development UI validation workshops to catch issues early. This streamlined the handover process and sped up decision-making.

UX/UI Designer (Freelance)

Various Clients | Sep 2019 – Dec 2024

Led end-to-end design strategy and execution across diverse client industries, transforming raw concepts into market-ready products.

- **Commercial Impact:** Redesigned core user journeys for high-impact campaigns, contributing directly to a 36% lift in seasonal campaign sales.
- **Product Strategy & MVP:** Partnered with founders to define functional requirements, build intuitive user flows, and define core feature sets.
- **Research & Testing:** Ran generative research and usability testing to validate design direction, improve user engagement, and boost retention.
- **Scalable Systems:** Established cohesive design systems and brand guidelines to maintain visual consistency across platforms and support future scaling.

Community & Leadership

Co-lead

KANGARU | January 2026 - Present

I coordinate and drive a founder-led tech community in Melbourne, bringing together startup individuals and tech builders. My focus is on creating high-value spaces for ecosystem collaboration, managing strategic partnerships with local innovation hubs, and facilitating opportunities that help early-stage ventures scale.

- **Ecosystem Building:** Drive a founder-led tech community in Melbourne, connecting early-stage founders, builders, and ecosystem partners.

- **Event Operations:** Lead end-to-end event strategy, secure strategic venue partnerships with local innovation hubs, and manage speaker outreach.

Achievements

Vibe-a-thon

Archasangel | AWS | Vercel | Heidi | CDH | April 2026

First Prize Winner: Led design for Springboard, an MVP solution built to reduce friction in the hiring process for highly skilled contract professionals.

Technical Toolkit

- **Primary Design Tool:** Figma (Design Systems, Prototyping, Component Architecture)
- **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.2 Compliance, Screen Reader Testing, Colour Contrast Analysis, Inclusive Design Audit
- **AI-Enhanced Workflow:** Antigravity (Rapid Prototyping), LLMs for Thematic Research Clustering and Interview Scripting.
- **Creative Suite:** Adobe XD, Photoshop, Illustrator, Firefly
- **Analytics & Research:** Hotjar, Adobe Analytics, Google Lighthouse, SEMrush
- **Project Management:** Jira, Confluence, Monday (Agile Methodology)
- **Technical Knowledge:** HTML, CSS, and various CMS (Contentful, Shopify, Webflow, Salesforce)

Qualifications

Institute of Modern Art
Bachelor of Arts

Animation Lyceum
Advanced Diploma of Arts

Liz Brown
WCAG 2.2 Web Accessibility